

THE ARTS OF ROME

Every civilization has its artistic side, and the Romans certainly had theirs. There was so much more to Roman life than trips to the savage arena and the thrills and spills race track. Romans prided themselves on being educated, artistic, and cultured people. To them, it was everyone else who was brutal and barbaric.

Getting an education

There were no laws that said children had to go to school, and many, especially the children of poor people, had no schooling at all. Education was entirely the responsibility of one's parents. So if someone grew up not knowing how to read, write, or count, they could blame it on their parents!

Girls were usually educated at home, where they learned to read, write, spin, weave, keep accounts, and sometimes play musical instruments. Boys

from the nice part of town were privately educated at home by personal teachers, who were usually slaves or former slaves. Most other boys were sent to schools, if their parents could afford it. Schools consisted of



A TEACHER GIVES A LESSON TO A GROUP OF PUPILS.